Dies Domini: Is Saturday the True Sabbath?

Dec 11, 2008 Jacob Michael

While I was preparing to receive the sacrament of Confirmation, I was asked to memorize the Ten Commandments and the Six Precepts of the Church; included in those Six Precepts was the command "to assist at Mass on all Sundays and holy days of obligation."[1] Growing up as a Protestant, I always went to worship services on Sundays and never gave it a second thought; from my earliest days it was just understood that worshiping God is what you do, and Sunday is when you do it. But why? Why is Sunday the day of worship? Why not Saturday, since that was the day on which God rested from Creation, and it was the day that was observed by the Jews of the Old Testament as "the Sabbath" for five thousand years?

My family very recently had the great grace of hosting a traditional Catholic priest in our home for several days, and while he was with us, I had — for the first time — the even greater grace of assisting at Holy Mass in the role of an altar server. As Father coached me through the various gestures and motions, I was once again impressed by one fact about the Church: nothing is left to chance. Everything, and I mean *everything*, has a reason behind it. It should come as no surprise, then, that the Church has a reason — and a very good reason, at that — for honoring Sunday in a special way as the day set aside for the worship of the One True God. In fact, the answer is right there in the catechism:

Why does the Church command us to keep Sunday as the Lord's day?

The Church commands us to keep Sunday as the Lord's day because on Sunday Christ rose from the dead, and on Sunday the Holy Spirit descended upon the Apostles. For these reasons the Church changed the Lord's day from Saturday to Sunday.[2]

These reasons are more than satisfactory for the Catholic. If it were not enough for us that two of the greatest events of the true religion (the Resurrection of Christ and the Descent of the Holy Ghost on Pentecost) fell on a Sunday, certainly it would be enough that the Holy Church, into whose hands Our Lord has bequeathed His divine authority, has ruled that Sunday be the "day of the Lord." Sadly, amongst those inventors of new religions outside the Catholic Church, there is always something to be found in the Church's teachings about which they can contend. Some Judaistic Protestants, not satisfied with accusing the Church of inventing (out of whole cloth, of course) Purgatory, the Mass, confession, the Marian dogmas, the papacy, indulgences, veneration of the saints, etc., go on also to accuse the Church of violating Scripture and breaking the commandments of God with regard to the *day* on which we worship.

The Sign of the Anti-Christ?

There have been a handful of sects throughout Church history who have insisted that the Jewish Sabbath — that is, Saturday — is the day on which God desires us to worship Him. One writer says, "numerous attempts have been made to revive the keeping of the seventh day. . . . A party tried it at the Reformation. . . . In England the Seventh Day Baptists tried it two hundred and fifty years ago. . . . Seventh-Day Adventists have tried it for fifty years. . . . "[3] To this list of defectors can also be added the Jehovah's Witnesses and a handful of other sects.[4] I have chosen to narrow my examinations to include only the arguments and objections of the Seventh-Day Adventists. Of the above groups mentioned, only the Seventh-Day Adventists and the Jehovah's Witnesses seem to have any public recognition (and therefore, published works with which to interact), and of those two, only the Seventh-Day Adventists can reasonably be called "Protestant."[5]

Seventh-Day Adventism is itself an off-shoot of the Adventist sect, which sprang up as late as the mid-1800s; "Adventism" refers to this group's particular emphasis on prophecy and the "Advent" or Second Coming of Christ. After asserting that the return of Christ would be in the year 1843, and then following up this miscalculation by proclaiming that His return was postponed until the following year, the original Adventists

quickly self-destructed. A "remnant" of this group managed to save face by asserting that Christ *had* returned as predicted, but that He had returned in a "spiritual" manner. Subsequently, one "Joseph Bates became the apostle of the Sabbath to James and Ellen White, the two other founders of Seventh-Day Adventism. Bates, in turn, had received the light on the seventh day from T.M. Preble, who had accepted the Sabbath in the summer of 1844."[6]

In addition to their peculiar insistence that the seventh day (Saturday) be honored as the Lord's Day, the Seventh-Day Adventists (hereafter "SDAs") also teach that the souls of the wicked will be completely annihilated at the Judgment. Another characteristic of SDAs, as we will soon see, is their deeply-rooted belief that the papacy is the anti-Christ, and that the Church's decision to mark Sunday as the Lord's day is irrefutable proof of this assertion.

In the prophet Daniel's vision of the four beasts, which represented four future kingdoms, the fourth beast/kingdom "shall be greater than all the kingdoms . . . the ten horns of the same kingdom, shall be ten kings: and another shall rise up after them, and he shall be mightier than the former . . . he shall speak words against the High One, and shall crush the saints of the most High: <u>and he shall think himself able to change times and laws</u>, and they shall be delivered into his hand until a time, and times, and half a time" (Dan. 7:23-25, author's underscore for emphasis).[7] This last part of the prophecy, wherein the anti-Christ will "think himself able to change times and laws," is where the SDAs pick up their argument. Ellen White wrote:

Prophecy had declared that the papacy was to "think to change times and laws." . . .

Satan tampered with the fourth commandment[8] also, and essayed to set aside the ancient Sabbath … and in its stead to exalt the festival observed by the heathen as "the venerable day of the sun." . . . That the attention of the people might be called to the Sunday, it was made a festival in honor of the resurrection of Christ. . . .

The Last Supper by Champaigne

A few years after the issue of Constantine's decree, the bishop of Rome conferred on the Sunday the title of Lord's day.[9]

Mrs. White goes on further to say that "No such honor was given to the day by Christ or his [sic] apostles. The observance of Sunday as a Christian institution has its origin in that 'mystery of lawlessness' which, even in Paul's day, had begun its work."[10] Thus, the claim is made that a) Christ and His apostles observed Saturday as the Lord's day, not Sunday, b) the honor given to Sunday originates in paganism's worship of the sun, c) the pope (working with Satan) changed the Sabbath from Saturday to Sunday, and d) this fulfills the prophecy of Daniel concerning the anti-Christ.

Turning to the book of St. John's Apocalypse, SDAs find still further proof for their claim. The text says:

And I beheld another beast coming up out of the earth; and he had two horns like a lamb, and he spake as a dragon … And he causeth all, both small and great, rich and poor, free and bond, to receive a mark in their right hand, or in their foreheads. (Apoc. 13:11, 16; KJV)

If any man worship the beast … and receive his mark in his forehead, or in his hand, the same shall drink of the wine of the wrath of God … and they have no rest day nor night, who worship the beast and his image, and whosoever receiveth the mark of his name. Here is the patience of the saints: here are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of Jesus. (Apoc. 14:9-12, KJV, author's underscore for emphasis)

Concerning this "mark of the beast," Mrs. White wrote, "It is the mark of the first beast, or the papacy … the Roman Church … was to think to change times and laws … an act of obedience to papal laws would be a mark of allegiance to the pope in the place of God."[11] Stating the case more explicitly still, she says, "The change of the Sabbath is the sign, or mark, of the authority of the Romish Church. Those who, understanding the claims of the fourth commandment, choose to observe the false in place of the true Sabbath, are thereby paying homage to that power by which alone it is commanded. The change in the fourth commandment is the change pointed out in the prophecy [of Daniel], and the keeping of the counterfeit Sabbath is the reception of the mark [of the beast]."[12]

An illumination taken from the book of the Apocalypse depicting the beast and the false prophet

T.M. Preble, in his *Tract, Showing that the Seventh Day should be Observed as the Sabbath, Instead of the First Day* (1845), argues that God established the seventh day specifically as *His* Sabbath day, that Christ and the apostles all observed the seventh day as the Sabbath, and that nowhere in Scripture are we ever told that this eternal commandment was abolished. He writes, "Jesus Christ brought in a new covenant which continued the sign of the Sabbath … if the children of God are the true Israel, and if the Sabbath was given as a sign forever, and a perpetual covenant, I ask, how can it be abolished while there is one Israelite remaining to claim the promise?"[13] It seems, however, that SDAs cannot fully agree on exactly when the Church or pope made this change. Mrs. White, quoted above, said that "the bishop of Rome" made the change, a "few years after the issue of Constantine's decree," which would be in the early-to-mid fourth century; Preble, in his *Tract*, says that in "A.D. 603 … *Pope Gregory* passed a law abolishing the *seventh day Sabbath*, and establishing the first day."[14] In still another source, the *Advent Review* (October 9, 1888), we find it said

that "The first authoritative action of the Catholic church in substituting the Sunday for the Sabbath of the Lord, was that of the Council of Laodicea in the year 364."[15]

Obviously, then, the challenge to the Catholic comes on several fronts; first, we must examine the argument that the Seventh-DaySabbath was truly "given as a sign forever, and a perpetual covenant"; next, we must show from Scripture that the Apostles did, in fact, worship on Sunday; finally, we have to answer the accusation that it was a pope (or council) who imposed the change, and that this was not done until (at the earliest) the mid-to-late fourth century.

What Saith the Scriptures?

The SDAs have a point, do they not, when they say that the Seventh-Day-Sabbath was given as a perpetual sign? We read in the book of Exodus that God said, "Let the children of Israel keep the Sabbath, and celebrate it in their generations. It is an everlasting covenant between me and the children of Israel, and a perpetual sign" (Ex. 31:16-17, author's underscore for emphasis). Preble asks, "Has the day ever been changed? If so, *when* and *where*? Please point to the chapter and verse."[16] Mrs. White likewise says, "For this change the only authority claimed is that of the church. Here the papal power openly sets itself above God."[17]

One thing that the astute reader will recognize immediately, however, is that *twice* in the Exodus text mention is made of the perpetuity of this command ("everlasting covenant … perpetual sign"), and this is balanced by exactly *two* qualifiers that identify for whom this command was given: "Let the children of Israel keep the Sabbath … It is an everlasting covenant between me and the children of Israel. . . ." (emphasis added) Obviously, then, there is something very specific (indeed, very *temporal*) about this command; it is given for the children of Israel — an everlasting covenant and sign, to be sure, but a covenant and sign "between me and the children of Israel." That covenant, however, was broken by the "children of Israel," and ultimately, a New Covenant was inaugurated. The SDAs take a bit of liberty, then, in saying that because we are the "spiritual Israel" (which we are), we are therefore under the obligation to obey the covenant commands given to *literal* Israel.

In fact, the Seventh-Day-sign of the covenant is not the only "everlasting" sign that was given by God to Israel, only to be abrogated later. When God made His covenant with Abraham in Genesis 17, He imposed a covenant sign that — like the Seventh-Day-Sabbath — was said to be eternal: "This is my covenant which you shall observe between me and you, and thy seed after thee: All the male kind of you shall be circumcised . . . that it may be for a sign of the covenant between me and you. . . . And my covenant shall be in your flesh for a perpetual covenant" (Gen. 17:10-13, emphasis added). Of course, as we all know (or *should* know), the ritual of circumcision was abrogated with the coming of the New Covenant, and officially done away with at the Council of Jerusalem in Acts 15. That is to say, the situation with the "perpetual covenant" of circumcision is nearly identical to that of the Seventh-DaySabbath; we could easily aim Preble's words at St. Peter when he decreed that circumcision was no longer required: "Please point to chapter and verse!" Mrs. White's remarks about the Sabbath could have easily been on the lips of the Judaizers with regard to circumcision: "For this change the only authority claimed is that of the church!"

We will see later, in our survey of the Church Fathers on the subject, that Scriptural support for the abrogation of the Seventh-Day-Sabbath was hardly lacking; it was foretold generations before Christ in the holy prophets, so it can hardly be said that the change was made solely on the authority of the Church. But even if it were so, even if our only support for the change rested on the Church alone, this too would be Scriptural, if we would only recall the words of Our Lord to the "Magisterium" of the infant Church: "Amen I say to you, whatsoever you shall bind upon earth, shall be bound also in heaven; and whatsoever you shall loose upon earth, shall be loosed also in heaven" (Matt. 18:18, emphasis added). If any authority on earth has the jurisdiction to make these changes, to "loose" us from the requirements of circumcision and the Seventh-Day-Sabbath, it is the Church.

Thus we can establish at least the basic principle to support our case: 1) the fact that the Seventh-Day-Sabbath is called "perpetual" need not necessarily mean that it could never be abrogated, because the covenant of circumcision also was called a "perpetual sign," and it *was* abrogated; 2) Our Lord bequeathed to the Church the authority to make precisely these kinds of disciplinary and juridical decisions, which authority we can see being exercised at the Jerusalem Council in Acts 15.

If we must look for positive evidence to couple with our negative evidence, it must be admitted (for what little difference it makes) that there is no *explicit* verse in Scripture that abrogates the Seventh-Day-Sabbath. The SDA may wish to cling to this fact, and indeed, he must; it is the last shaky piece of his foundation that is left to him after all the Scriptural evidence has been compiled and joined to the unanimous testimony of the early Church. While there may be no *explicit* statement in Scripture to the effect that the Seventh-Day-Sabbath is no longer binding, there is plenty of *implicit* evidence, both in the statements of the Apostles and in their actions.

We may begin with the words of St. Paul taken from numerous places in his various epistles. In his Epistle to the Romans, he speaks of how the Christians are to treat "him that is weak in faith" (cf. 14:1-5), that is, the Jewish converts who still had scruples about following the Mosaic Law. As examples, he contrasts the strong Christian who "believeth that he may eat all things" with "he that is weak," who will "eat herbs"; he contrasts the strong Christian who "judgeth *every* day" with the weak who "judgeth between day and day." The sense of the passage is somewhat lost in the English of the Douay-Rheims, because the Greek literally speaks of the weak Christian who "separates day from day," or as the RSV (Revised Standard Version) has it, "One man esteems one day as better than another, while another man esteems all days alike." (14:5, emphasis added) For the Christian, *every* day is the Sabbath, for he worships Jesus Christ, the "Lord of the Sabbath." (Mark 2:28) Indeed, in my more feisty moments I am tempted to simply tweak the nose of the SDAs and say, "I don't know what you're talking about — Catholics *do* worship on the seventh day, and on the sixth, and on the fifth, and the fourth, and every other day of the week, because our priests offer the Sacrifice of the Mass every single day!" The SDAs, however, like their ancient Jewish counterpart, want to "judge between day and day."

In St. Paul's Epistle to the Galatians, a hair-raising written rebuke of the Galatian Christians who were being tempted to return to an observance of the Jewish ritual laws, he says, "You observe days and months and times, and years. I am afraid of you, lest perhaps I have laboured in vain among you" (Gal. 4:10-11, emphasis added). His reference here, of course, is to the Jewish festival days, such as the Sabbath, the new moon feasts ("months"), the yearly festivals, etc. In *The Epistle of Mathetes to Diognetus* (ca. 130), the Apostolic Father, Mathetes, sees this passage as referring precisely to the Jewish Sabbath: he speaks of "[the Jews'] scrupulosity concerning meats," "their superstition as respects the Sabbaths," "their boasting about circumcision, and their fancies about fasting and the new moons," and pronounces all of it "utterly ridiculous and unworthy of notice."[18]

Most explicit of all is St. Paul's Epistle to the Colossians: "Let no man, therefore, judge you in meat or in drink, or in respect of a festival day, or of the new moon, or of the sabbaths, which are a shadow of things to come, but the body *is* of Christ" (Col. 2:16-17, emphasis added). The SDAs will want to argue that St. Paul's "Sabbaths" are different from *the* Sabbath which God sanctified and consecrated as a perpetual holy day,[19] but they bear the burden of demonstrating why the word *sabbaton* means "yearly festival Sabbaths" here in Colossians 2, but means *the* Sabbath day every other time it is used in the New Testament.[20]

Joined to these proofs we also may look at the Gospels, wherein we will discover something that the early Church knew and took for granted, the very reason *why* the change was made to honor the "Sabbath" on Sunday instead of Saturday. We find in St. John's Gospel these words: "And on the first day of the week, Mary Magdalen cometh early, when it was yet dark, unto the sepulchre: and she saw the stone taken away from the sepulchre. . . ." (John 20:1, emphasis added). We all know the rest of the story, do we not? It was on this Sunday, this "first day of the week," that Mary Magdalen and the holy women discovered that Our Lord had risen from the dead.

Later on in the same chapter, as if to emphasize the importance of this day, St. John writes: "Now when it was late the same day, the first of the week, and the doors were shut, where the disciples were gathered together, for fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood in the midst and said to them: Peace be to you" (John 20:19, emphasis added). On this occasion, Our Lord breathed upon the Apostles and gave them the Holy Ghost, saying, "Whose sins you shall forgive, they are forgiven them: and whose *sins* you shall retain, they are retained" (v. 23).

Still later in this chapter we read, "And after eight days, again his disciples were within, and Thomas with them. Jesus cometh, the doors being shut, and stood in the midst, and said: Peace be to you" (John 20:26, emphasis added). This is an exact literary repetition of verse 19, with the exception that it is not now "the

first of the week," but "after eight days." That is to say, this event (the story goes on to relate how Our Lord revealed Himself to St. Thomas for the first time) took place — to use Catholic terminology — *on the octave* of Easter Sunday. The Resurrection, the commissioning of the Apostles, and the revelation to St. Thomas all took place on Sunday. If we may be granted a bit of liberty in interpreting the texts of St. John's Gospel with a hint of "mysticism," we may certainly say that St. John wishes us to understand that Sunday is the day upon which we meet the Risen Christ; Mary Magdalen met Him on that day; the Apostles met Him on that day; St. Thomas met Him in a special way on that day; we too will meet Him on this day (or so St. John seems to be relating to us by implication).

Count fifty days forward, and you arrive at the Jewish Feast of Pentecost, upon which occasion Our Lord sent the Holy Ghost to confirm the Apostles, thus giving "birth" to the Church: this, too, was a Sunday. What would be more natural, then, but for the early Church to give a special honor and reverence to this day? What would be their reason for continuing to honor the "holy day" which was a sign of the Old Covenant, when the holy Apostles were continually impressing upon the minds of the faithful that the Old Covenant had been fulfilled in Christ and superseded by the gospel?

The SDAs are quick to point out that the Apostles continued to give honor to the Seventh-Day Sabbath by going up to the temple every Sabbath day. But there is no reason the Apostles should not have done this. They were still Jews, after all, and the radical break with Judaism did not happen until God Himself radically broke the Jewish religion by sending the Romans to destroy the Jerusalem Temple in 70 AD. Until that time, there was a necessary period of overlap, during which these born-and-bred Jews (who also happened to be Apostles of the New Covenant) did what was natural to them: they went up to the temple to pray at the appointed times. (The temple was still a holy place, the Old Covenant ritual observances — as the Church explains it — were dead but not deadly.) What they most assuredly did *not* do, as we may infer from St. Paul's blistering rebuke of the Galatians, is treat these Jewish customs as binding and necessary for salvation. As the Church moved on into history, many Jewish converts continued to practice certain Jewish customs, and the Church tolerated this (though, significantly, treating it as a weakness) so long as no one said that these customs were binding or salvific.

Pentecost Sunday

While some Jewish converts continued to observe the Seventh-Day-Sabbath, it also is true that the new Christians met together to worship their Risen Lord on Sunday, the day of His Resurrection. Thus, we read in Acts 20 that "on the first day of the week, when we were assembled to break bread, Paul discoursed with [the believers in Troas] … And he continued his speech until midnight … And a certain young man named Eutychus, sitting on the window, being oppressed with a deep sleep . . . by occasion of his sleep fell from the third loft down and was taken up dead. To whom, when Paul had gone down, he laid himself upon him and, embracing him, said: Be not troubled, for his soul is in him. Then going up and breaking bread and tasting, and having talked a long time to them, until daylight, so he departed" (Acts 20:7-11, emphasis added).

I have taken the time to quote a good portion of this story, because there is something mystical in the whole thing. Not only do we have the mention of "the first day of the week" combined with the practice of meeting together *as an assembly* "to break bread" (the early Church's term for the Mass), we also see several interesting motifs. One scholar of St. Luke's writings says that "this gesture [of breaking bread] is closely related to the 'death' and the 'resurrection' of Eutychus. . . . We note also the imagery of the night and the dawn, related to the negative moment and the positive moment, respectively."[21] Thus in this single narrative, we have the Eucharist, coupled with a kind of "death" and "resurrection," which takes place in the context of a transition from the night to the dawn, all on the "first day of the week" (not to mention the seemingly-superfluous detail that the young man fell "from the third loft")! This may not be an explicit text that plainly says "the seventh day Sabbath was abrogated in favor of a Sunday Sabbath," but it is more than enough proof for those who have eyes to see.

The Anti-Christ Came Early

At this point, we will examine claims of the SDAs that it was a pope or a Church council which, in the mid-fourth century at the earliest, imposed the exchange of the Seventh-Day-Sabbath for the Sunday Sabbath, thus fulfilling the prophecy of Daniel concerning the anti-Christ who would "think to change" the holy law. We may begin with the witness of St. Ignatius of Antioch, writing around 110 AD (within living memory of the Apostles, and within a mere ten years of the death of St. John):

If then those who had walked in ancient practices attained unto newness of hope, no longer observing Sabbaths but fashioning their lives after the Lord's day, on which our life also arose through Him and through His death . . . if this be so, how shall we be able to live apart from Him?[22] (emphasis added)

What is most noteworthy in this passage is that St. Ignatius specifically contrasts the Old Covenant "Sabbaths" with "the Lord's day," which is then identified with the day of His Resurrection. This is to the point because the SDAs often claim that every reference to "the Lord's day" in the New Testament must be *assumed* to be referring to the Seventh-Day-Sabbath, since that *was* the Lord's day in the Old Covenant and there is no Scriptural warrant for calling Sunday "the Lord's day." Preble, for example, says "Rev. i. 10, is the only other place that can be construed to favor the first day — John says 'I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day.' — Now, who knows whether he meant the first or the seventh day? I think the latter, because it is called 'the Sabbath of the Lord thy God,' but the first, is nowhere called so!!"[23] Here, however, we have the witness of a New Testament Christian who lived during the episcopal reign of St. John (whose words in Apoc. 1:10 are here under dispute), who no doubt studied under St. John before the Apostle's exile, and who afterwards became himself the bishop of St. John's churches in Asia Minor.[24] St. Ignatius gives us explicit testimony that in this age of the Church "the Lord's day" referred to Sunday, and *not* to the old "Sabbaths."

We can then look to the *Didache*, which purports to be the teaching of "The Twelve," and is generally agreed to have been written between 90-100 AD, again, well within living memory of the Apostles. There we find:

And on the Lord's own day gather yourselves together and break bread and give thanks,[25] first confessing your transgressions, that your sacrifice may be pure.[26]

Again, recalling that there is no historical evidence that the early Christians ever met together for weekly worship on any other day than Sunday, this is more implicit evidence that the early Christians referred to Sunday (the day when they would "break bread") as "the Lord's own day."

St. Justin Martyr, writing between 140-160 AD, wrote in defense of Christianity to the Roman Emperor, and said that "on the day called Sunday, all who live in cities or in the country gather together to one place, and the memoirs of the apostles or the writings of the prophets are read, as long as time permits, etc."; he goes on to describe the average Sunday Mass in great detail. More instructive still is St. Justin's dialogue with Trypho, *a Jew*, on precisely the issue of the Sabbath and other Jewish customs: "But the Gentiles . . . shall receive the inheritance along with the patriarchs and . . . the just men who are descended from Jacob, even though they neither keep the Sabbath, nor are circumcised, nor observe the feasts."[27] Trypho asks St. Justin if those who *do* keep the Jewish customs, even after becoming Christians, can be saved. St. Justin responds, "such a one will be saved, if he does not strive in every way to persuade other men . . . telling them that they will not be saved unless they do so . . . [I]f some, through weak-mindedness, wish to observe such institutions as were given by Moses . . . yet choose to live with the Christians and the faithful . . . not inducing them either to be circumcised like themselves, or to keep the Sabbath . . . then I hold that we ought

to join ourselves to such, and associate with them in all things as kinsmen and brethren."[28] Notice that, like St. Paul, St. Justin sees those Jewish converts who wish to continue observing the Sabbath as influenced by "weak-mindedness."

In his epistle, St. Barnabas, companion of St. Paul (and one of the seventy-two disciples of Our Lord), quotes from Isaiah 1:13, "Your new moons and your Sabbath I cannot endure," and comments, "Ye perceive how He speaks: *Your present Sabbaths are not acceptable to Me, but . . . I shall make a beginning of the eighth day* . . . Wherefore, also, we keep the eighth day with joyfulness, the day also on which Jesus rose again from the dead."[29]

Tertullian, writing at the beginning of the third century, says, "In the same way, if we devote Sunday to rejoicing, from a far different reason than Sun-worship, we have some resemblance to those of you who devote the day of Saturn [*i.e.*, Saturn's Day, or "Saturday"] to ease and luxury . . ."[30] Again he says, "We neither accord with the Jews in their peculiarities in regard to food, nor in their sacred days, nor even in their well-known bodily sign. . . ."[31] More explicitly still, he spends an entire chapter of his *Answer to the Jews* on the question of the Sabbath: "[W]e (Christians) understand that we still more ought to observe a sabbath from all 'servile work' always, and not only every seventh day, but through all time . . . For the Scriptures point to a sabbath eternal and a sabbath temporal . . . it is manifest that the force of such precepts was temporary, and respected the necessity of present circumstances; and that it was not with a view to its observance in perpetuity that God formerly gave them such a law."[32]

St. Cyprian in the mid-third century wrote of the sacramental foreshadowing of the eighth day: "In respect of the observance of the eighth day in the Jewish circumcision of the flesh, a sacrament was given beforehand in shadow and in usage . . . because the eighth day, that is, the first day after the Sabbath, was to be that on which the Lord should rise again . . . and give us circumcision of the spirit, the eighth day, that is, the first day after the Sabbath, and the Lord's day, went before in the figure."[33]

We find in the mid-third century *Apostolic Constitutions*, "Assemble yourselves together every day . . . in the morning saying the sixty-second Psalm, and in the evening the hundred and fortieth, but principally on the Sabbath-day. And on the day of our Lord's resurrection, which is the Lord's day, meet more diligently. . . . Otherwise what apology will he make to God who does not assemble on that day to hear the saving word concerning the resurrection . . .?"[34]

Near the end of the third century, St. Victorinus, in his *On the Creation of the World*, is more explicit still in his statement that Christians do *not* keep the Jewish Sabbath specifically because they do not wish to be identified with the Jews: "On the [sixth] day we are accustomed to fast rigorously, that on the Lord's day we may go forth to our bread with giving of thanks. And let the parasceve [*i.e.*, the Sabbath] become a rigorous fast, lest we should appear to observe any Sabbath with the Jews, which Christ Himself, the Lord of the Sabbath, says by His prophets that 'His soul hateth'; which Sabbath He in His body abolished."[35] Note again the reference to Sunday as "the Lord's day."

Ellen White, founder of the Seventh Day Adventists

Finally, we come to the early-to-mid-fourth century, right about the time when — according to the SDAs — the pope and/or council imposed for the first time the 'demonic' change in the days of worship. Here we find the words of Eusebius, the "Father of Church History," and he says, "All those who have enjoyed the testimony of righteousness, from Abraham himself back to the first man, were Christians in fact if not in name . . . They did not care about circumcision of the body, neither do we. They did not care about observing Sabbaths, nor do we."[36] Later, in describing the *heresy* of the Ebionite sect, he writes, "The Sabbath and the rest of the discipline of the Jews they observed just like them, but at the same time, like us, they celebrated the Lord's days as a memorial of the resurrection of the Saviour. Wherefore, in consequence of such a course they received the name of Ebionites, which signified the poverty of their understanding."[37] Notice again: the Ebionites are heretics, and *they* act like Jews in their observance of the Sabbath — in *contradistinction* to the Christians; also, the "Lord's day" is the "memorial of the resurrection": Sunday.

With this last testimony I should be content to close, but I cannot resist the temptation to quote one last Church Father, one of the greatest of that age: St. Augustine. The great bishop of Hippo, recall, was writing in the early fifth century, shortly after (the SDAs say) the pope/council had introduced the novelty of worshiping on Sundays. But let us hear the testimony of St. Augustine, who (were the SDAs correct in their assertions) should testify that he once worshiped on Saturdays but does so no longer due to the papal decree; or he should at least make *mention* of this papal decree. Rather, he says:

The Lord's day, however, has been made known not to the Jews, but to Christians, by the resurrection of the Lord, and from Him it began to have the festive character which is proper to it . . . [T]he sacramental import of the 8th number, as signifying the resurrection, was by no means concealed from the holy men of old who were filled with the spirit of prophecy. . . . [N]evertheless before the resurrection of the Lord, it was reserved

and hidden, and the Sabbath alone was appointed to be observed, because before that event there was indeed the repose of the dead . . . but there was not any instance of the resurrection of one . . . over whom death should no longer have dominion; this being done in order that, from the time when such a resurrection did take place in the Lord's own body . . . the day upon which He rose, the eighth day namely (which is the same with the first of the week), should begin to be observed as the Lord's day . . . He had come . . . to declare the mystery of the day now known as the Lord's day, the eighth namely, which is also the first of the week.[38]

Conclusion

We have seen how the Scriptures show that not all "perpetual" signs of the Old Covenant were carried over into the New; we have seen how the Gospel of St. John gives evidence for the Catholic view by presenting a risen Christ who appears to His *ecclesia* on Sundays; we saw how the practice of the early Church (as early as the Acts of the Apostles) was to "break bread" together on "the first day of the week"; finally, we saw that the unanimous testimony of the early Church Fathers is that the "Lord's day" is Sunday; that all the Fathers understood the Resurrection to be the *reason* why Sunday was given special honor; that by the end of the Apostolic age, only the Jews kept the Sabbath, and Christians chose to fast on that day instead, lest they should be taken for Jews; and that all the Fathers understood that the prophets [Isaias explicitly] had foretold a day when the Jewish Sabbath would be abolished.

And so we end where we began; the process of discovering the truth, which takes us through many passages of Scripture and many books of the ancient Fathers, leads us to the same conclusion stated so succinctly in the *Baltimore Catechism*: "The Church commands us to keep Sunday as the Lord's day because on Sunday Christ rose from the dead."

Editor's Note: The reader can benefit from the following lesson garnered from the teachings of St. Augustine: Before the Incarnation, the people of God looked forward to the coming of Christ, the great Event to come; thus it was appropriate to set aside the last day of the God-given cycle of the week for common worship. After the Incarnation this liturgical 'anticipation' would be senseless. Now, we members of the Church base our faith on the Event that has come to pass two thousand years ago. Therefore, we spend the days looking back on the first day of the week, the day of our new beginning, the day of the *Sun*, "the Orient on high hath visited us." (Luke 1:78)

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[1] Father Bennet, C.P., *Saint Joseph Baltimore Catechism No. 2* [Revised Edition] (New York: Catholic Book Publishing Co., 1962-1969), p. 134 (q. 281).

[2] Ibid., p. 118 (q. 235).

[3] D.M. Canright, *Seventh-Day Adventism Refuted in a Nutshell* (Grand Rapids, MI: Baker Book House, 1962), p. 43.

[4] For example, just a few blocks down the street from where I live, there stands "Abundant Life International Ministries," headed by the "Apostle Arthur Bailey," and advertising a "Saturday Sabbath" service.

[5] The Jehovah's Witnesses do not even merit the title "professing Christians," since they deny the divinity of Our Lord.

[6] George R. Knight, *1844 and the Rise of Sabbatarian Adventism* (Hagerstown, MD: Review and Herald Publishing Association, 1994), p. 144.

[7] Unless otherwise noted, all Scriptural quotations are taken from the Douay-Rheims translation.

[8] **Nota Bene**: SDAs say that the Church "presumed to expunge from the law of God the second commandment, forbidding image worship, and to divide the tenth commandment, in order to preserve the number" (White, *Controversy*, p. 54); thus, when an SDA refers to the "fourth commandment," he means the *third* commandment, according to the Catholic division, the command to "keep holy the Sabbath."

[9] Ellen Gould White, *The Great Controversy Between Christ and Satan* [Third Edition] (Pacific Press: Oakland, CA, 1886), pp. 54-55.

[10] White, *Controversy*, p. 57.

[11] Ibid., p. 279.

[12] Ibid., p. 281.

[13] Tract reproduced in full in Knight, *1844*, p. 158.

[14] Knight, *1844*, p. 161.

[15] Quoted in Canright, *Refuted*, p. 49.

[16] Quoted in Knight, *1844*, p. 157.

[17] White, *Controversy*, p. 280, emphasis added.

[18] *The Epistle of Mathetes to Diognetus*, cap. IV, emphasis added; unless otherwise noted, all quotes from the Church Fathers are taken from the Roberts and Donaldson edition of *The Ante-Nicene Fathers*, in ten volumes, online at *The Christian Classics Ethereal Library* (http://www.ccel.org/fathers2/).

[19] For example, Michael Scheifler, in a response to me, wrote "The seventh day Saturday Sabbath was first kept at the end of creation week, and was inscribed by the hand of God in the stones of God's Law, the Ten Commandments, and so is separate and distinct from the yearly festival Sabbaths that began with Israel's release from Egypt on the first Passover, and were a part of the Mosaic ceremonial law." (http://biblelight.net/CAI-sabbath.htm).

[20] Cf. Mt. 12:1-12, Mt. 24:20, Mt. 28:1, Mk. 1:21, Mk. 2:23-28, Mk. 3:2-4, Mk. 16:1-9, Lk. 4:16, Lk. 6:1-9, Lk. 13:10-16, Acts 13:14-44, Acts 15:21, Acts 16:13, etc. The sole exception is 1 Cor. 16:2, where *sabbaton* is rendered as "week."

[21] Justin Taylor, "La Fraction Du Pain en Luc-Actes," in J. Verheyden (ed.), *The Unity of Luke-Acts* (Leuven: Leuven University Press: Peeters, 1999), p. 293; original text: "ce geste est étroitement lié à la 'mort' et à la 'résurrection' d'Eutychus … Nous notons aussi l'imagerie de la nuit et de l'aurore, liée respectivement au moment négatif et au moment positif." The translation is sufficiently rough that I must, unfortunately, take the blame for it myself.

[22] *Epistle to the Magnesians*, 9:1-2; J.B. Lightfoot translation, online at http://www.earlychristianwritings.com/text/ignatius-magnesians-lightfoot.html

[23] Quoted in Knight, *1844*, p. 159.

[24] In the Apocalypse, St. John writes to the "seven churches," at Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamus, Thyatira, Sardis, Philadelphia, and Laodicea; at the end of his life, while on his way to martyrdom in Rome, St. Ignatius also dispatched seven letters to seven churches, including the churches at Ephesus, Smyrna, and Philadelphia.

[25] Greek *eucharistesate*, from which we get our word "Eucharist."

[26] *The Didache*, 14:1; J.B. Lightfoot translation, online at http://www.earlychristianwritings.com/text/didache-lightfoot.html

[27] *Dialogue with Trypho*, 26, (emphasis added).

[28] Ibid., 47. (emphasis added)

[29] *The Epistle of Barnabas*, 15. (emphasis added)

[30] *Apology*, 16. (emphasis added)

[31] Ibid., 21.

[32] *An Answer to the Jews*, 4.

[33] *Epistle* 58:4. (emphasis added)

[34] *Apostolic Constitutions*, Book II, Sec. VII, LIX.

[35] *On the Creation of the World*, par. 4. (emphasis added)

[36] *Church History*, Book I, cap. IV, 6-8. (emphasis added)

[37] Ibid., Book III, cap. XXVII, 5-6. (emphasis added)

[38] *Letter* 55, cap. 13. (emphasis added)

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Best Newest Oldest

christopher

14 years ago

I personally do not see your point. This article is lengthy and meaningless. For a person who has an obligation to please God the best way he is instructed i don't see what you hope to achieve with this unnecessarily lengthy disputation of what the seventh-day adventists believe.
Seventh Day Adventists aside, Is the Sabbath commandment one of the ten commandments or not?
Of course it is! Exodus 20:8
Are the ten commandments covenant or not?
They are! Exodus 34:28
When the children of Israel did not keep the covenant God needed to make a new one right?
What was the problem the covenant or the people?
It was the people! Hebrews 8:8,10
In the new covenant were the ten commandments removed, changed or still kept?
They were maintained except they were now written on the hearts of the people! Jeremiah 31:31-33
In case you should know transgression of these commandment is what is sin!
You also dispute that the catholic church did not change the sabbath! hypocritical! who are you when the catholic has said in more than one of their publications that they changed the sabbath?
Are you not afraid of misleading God's children? Don't you fear God?
For your own information, the seventh day was not first given to the children of Israel. It was given to mankind. Genesis 2:3, Mark 2:27
It did not end with the children of Israel it will be kept even in the new Jerusalem. Isaiah 66:23.It is a back to back perpetual commandment along side other commandments. Man is not at liberty to use the day as he pleases. It is God's day!
Of the Apostles, there is plenty evidence in the bible that they kept the sabbath!

I am free for discussion of this topic and indeed our common salvation in Jesus Christ on csilondwa@yahoo.com. Thank you

6 0 Reply Share ›

Carol → christopher

2 years ago

WELL SAID, thank you.

0 0 Reply Share ›

Joshua

17 years ago

www.amazingdiscoveries.org

Walter Veith's "Total Onslaught" opens this all up in an easy to understand manner. Start at the begining.

4 0 Reply Share ›

Peterkeppel

14 years ago

lets just say for arguments sake you are right,when I stand b4 the Lord I guess I will have to apologize for following his example-luke 4;16 and peter-the first popes example,paul,and EVERYONE ELSE in recorded scripture-see Acts 13 and 15

3 0 Reply Share ›

ZenInsight → Peterkeppel

13 years ago

lol. Me too!! Oops...sorry Lord, your Apostles kept the Sabbath like 85 times, I was confused.

http://www.eliyah.com/85tim...

0 0 Reply Share ›

me

14 years ago

This article is a lengthy attempt to justify the Sunday sabbath.

It is simple.

1. The Church (the body of Christ, the members) has no authority to change any law set by God. Circumcision was not in the 10 commandments, and even so, maybe we should be still be circumcising.

2. When Cain and Able made their sacrifices unto God, one was rejected the other was accepted. Both were sacrifices of valuable personal possessions. Both were hard earned offerings offered to God. In the same way we could be worshiping our hearts out on Sunday but God may be frowning upon it. We cannot dictate the way, God commands us to keep the 7th day. He did not ask us kindly, he commands it!

3. If the day is of little significance the the RC church, why then dont they change revert to the 7th day and make everyone (including God) happy? The Sunday sabbath is just rebellious to me. Instead of finding excuses and justification isn't it easier to just do the simple thing and worship on the 7th?

I'm not a 7th day Adventist but I worship on the sabbath, Former Anglican

3 0 Reply Share ›

Peterkeppel ➦ me

14 years ago

I am not sda either,I am a seventh day baptist,there are also 7th day pentecostals,and others,the book of acts(that is the ACTS OF THE APOSTLES-UMMM -the ones whose example were supposed to follow) records that not only did paul meet with the jews on the sabbath,but the GENTILES sought that these words be preached the next sabbath...)

1 0 Reply Share ›

Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod ➦ me

14 years ago

me:
If the Church has NO AUTHORITY to change any law set by God, then please tell me why we are not all REQUIRED to circumcise. Then, please tell me why you would not stone your son if he were disobedient, as demanded in the Mosaic Law. Why, too, are we not scrupulously keeping kosher, observing the fasts and feasts of the Old Testament with precision, and offering oxes to the Cohenim to slaughter when our firstborn sons come into this world? You cannot pick and choose. The book of Leviticus is very demanding.

0 0 Reply Share ›

4fergr8ful ➦ Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

13 years ago

What people don't understand is that all the ceremonial laws were done away with at the cross with Jesus being the sacrificial lamb of God. This is why we no longer sacrifice the lamb at altars. All the covenants written by Moses have been made void. But the covenant between God and man written with the finger of God still stands. We all know which covenant that is.

3 0 Reply Share ›

ZenInsight ➦ 4fergr8ful

13 years ago

Yep. When you speak to those in the know, we hear you. No need to argue with Catholics. I wonder when Sabbath persecution will begin? Hmmmm.

http://www.catholicnewsagen...

http://www.ldausa.org/lda/a...

http://www.europeansundayal...

0 0 Reply Share ›

christopher → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

14 years ago

Brother Andre Marie, the law that can not be changed are the ten commandments. Which God calls the covenant! The Catholic Church believes in them, teaches them but has altered them tremendously. The ten commandments are not mosaic law. They are God's law. They were written by the finger of God. circumcision was not mosaic either. It was Abrahamaic. It served the same purpose as baptism now serves. It ushered male Jews into sonship of God as baptism does except now there is no female nor male. it is a whole new citizenship! All are the same. Sacrifices: we can not sacrifice oxes as one worthier has been sacrificed for us. Jesus Christ the Son of God whom those typified. Sacrifices were introduced because of transgression of the 10 commandments to stand until Jesus Christ!. They were meant to cleanse a transgressor of the 10 commandments. The blood of Jesus Christ does that. All we have to do is believe in him. Stoning our son: Come on Sir: we are no longer under the law of sin and death but grace. We can not stone but that does not exonerate the sinner! He is guilty unless he repents. You can not repent unless you believe in Jesus Christ! If we sin we have a mediator and an advocate with God Jesus Christ!

1 0 Reply Share ›

Maki Naky → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

8 years ago

And why don't you all
ow people to steal, kill or commit adultery? All the other nine commandments are binding except the fourth one? Have you read James 2:10?

0 0 Reply Share ›

Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → Maki Naky

8 years ago

Saint James is speaking of the New Law of Christ, a different Covenant than the Mosaic Law. If you insist on the Jewish Sabbatine observance (which you and all seventh-day folks DO), then why do you not accept all the other points of the Old Law, including the dietary laws and ceremonial precepts? Do you stone adulterous wives? Do you outlaw lobster?

0 0 Reply Share ›

Maki Naky → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

8 years ago

I would n't be so sure of that. Saint James puts that in perspective by citing examples of the law he is talking about. And the examples he gave are from the 10 commandments, not the other mosaic law.

Try to understand scripture in context. He cites do not commit adultery and do not kill to show that he is talking about the 10 commandments. Or would you say that because he did not mention, thou shall not mention the name of God in vain, it is ok to profane the name of God? Of course not. St James is simply saying all the 10 commandments are still binding and that includes the 4th one. And by the way, don't get the impression that the new covenant changed the law. The only difference is that now the law is written on our hearts and not on tables of stone. The 10 commandments will always stand. If you don't believe me, may be you will believe the Catholics : do some reading here http://biblelight.info/Sour... or here http://biblelight.net/c-rec.... Please try and read the entire articles, it will help you to understand because it is not from Sabbath keeping sources). If you are serious about learning about this and having an unbiased assessment, you can contact me. Let me add, you asked

see more

0 0 Reply Share ›

Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → Maki Naky

8 years ago

Where in the New Testament does it tell us, explicitly, which prescriptions and proscriptions of the Old Testaments are binding and which are not?

0 0 Reply Share ›

Maki Naky → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

8 years ago

And where in the new testament does it tell us explicitly that any of the 10 commandments have been abrogated? I gave you some links, please do some reading. I

0 0 Reply Share ›

Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → Maki Naky

8 years ago

I have no interest in reading your heresies. Seventh-Day-ism is a made up religion of modernity and has nothing to do with historical Christianity.

Should you have a reply to my very serious question, please give it.

1 0 Reply Share ›

Maki Naky → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

8 years ago

I knew you would say this. The articles I gave you are not from Seventh Day-ists. They are articles from Catholic trusted sources and it provides the answers to your so-called "very serious question". If you really want to know the answers to those questions and not

just interested in arguments, then read them. The Catholic Mirror of 1893 is not a modern-day Seventh- Day-ism heresy.

0 0 Reply Share ›

Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → Maki Naky

8 years ago

If you can reply to my question, then please do. If not, we can just end this.

Again, that question is...

> Where in the New Testament does it tell us, explicitly, which prescriptions and proscriptions of the Old Testaments are binding and which are not?

0 0 Reply Share ›

Jeri Pride → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

25 days ago edited

Bro Andre marie, you have read The Bible and Spirit of Prophecy. Continue to pray and ask The Holy Spirit to enlighten your mind to receive the truth as it is in Jesus. You are now responsible for the truths (gems) that you have learned. The Lord will hold you accountable to adhere to the truth. I will pray for you that you will be bold and stand up for The Lord and call sin by its right name. I will also pray that you will be a humble and willing follower of His word. James 4:6-17. The Sabbath is truly a blessing from God, embrace it!

0 0 Reply Share ›

John → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

9 years ago

because the laws that moses wrote were done away with not the ten commandments Jesus is the Lamb of God His blood has covered our sins because when you accept Jesus and ask him to come into your life you receive the Holy Spirit which gives you conviction in the heart and or your brain to help you not to sin to try to strengthen you from temptation.And also when the Jews stoned Stephen the first Christian martyr when Saul was there giving the order to stone him and then later on the road to Damascus when he was blinded by the Glory of Jesus and Saul became paul and the Jews rejected Jesus, Paul later says But he is a Jew, which is one inwardly; and circumcision is that of the heart, in the spirit, and notin the letter; whose praise is not of
men, but of God.

0 0 Reply Share ›

Ben → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

10 years ago

Paul addresses the issue of circumcision in Galatians. For God it is a matter of circumcision of the heart over circumcision of the flesh, as even stated by

of circumcision of the heart over circumcision of the flesh, as even stated by God in the Old Testament. As far as the laws regarding clean and unclean meats, we should keep those. There is not solid biblical evidence to show that anything has changed in that regard. As far as feasts of the OT Sanctuary. They were a symbol of the work of salvation fulfilled in Christ. In order to truly keep an OT feast you must sacrifice a lamb. Since Christ has already been sacrificed as our one true lamb, to sacrifice an earthly lamb in His place as part of feast keeping would be a denial of Christ. The OT Sanctuary and its services illustrated the plan of salvation and the work of Christ. It is important to study, because it gives us a better picture of what Christ has done for us. But we are no longer required to keep its ceremonies and feasts. You can pick and choose in the sense that you must separate the moral law of God from the ceremonial laws regarding the sanctuary and the civil laws given to Israel which obviously only applied to them in a very historical and limited context. God's moral law is what is most important.

0 0 Reply Share ›

turtle4aire

15 years ago

What the Lord has made, Man should not change !

2 0 Reply Share ›

Maki Naky

8 years ago

I reckon if you are a Catholic then it's a shame to write this article because then you contradict yourself. Catholic themselves justify all the claims of Seventh-Day Adventists. Catholic sources defend and debunk all the scriptures you used. So SDA's don't need to respond to such articles because Catholics themselves defend and justify everything they believe. In fact Catholics go to the extent of saying the SDAs are the only Christians who follow the Bible. Take a look at these sources and don't forget to read everything:
http://biblelight.info/Sour... ; http://biblelight.net/c-rec...
After this you may have to delete this article entirely and do your research well before writing

1 0 Reply Share ›

Ireadthebible

11 years ago

Only God has the authority to change laws. Not man. There is no verse in the bible that says Remember the first day of the week. Or God blessed the first day of the week. Christ came to fulfill the law not change it. Sunday worship is the Mark of the catholic church. I don't want the mark of the catholic church, I want the seal of God!

1 0 Reply Share ›

David

13 years ago

How sad that opinion is given as opposed to scripture for justification of the false sabbath...Sunday! Your church claims the validity of the 10 Commandments yet boldly breaks one citing church traditions..."teaching for doctrines the commandments of men". You forget that in James we are told: 2:10 "For whosoever shall keep the whole Law, yet offend it in ONE

that in James we are told: 2:10 "For whosoever shall keep the whole Law, yet offend it in ONE point, he is guilty of ALL". verse 12: " So, speak ye, and so do, as they that shall be judged by the Law of liberty". KJV Jesus himself said "if you Love me, keep my Commandments". We can justify anything we wish to suit our selfish wants. Jesus also said: "It is written, man shall not live by bread alone, but by EVERY WORD THAT PROCEEDETH OUT OF THE MOUTH OF GOD"...which the 10 Commandments most assuredly did! Also, for the record, the Lord gave the genuine Sabbath in the Garden of Eden Genesis 2:2,3. Somebody please tell me where the Jews were then? You can't be a child of Israel, if Israel hadn't been born yet; right? My conclusion, choose to believe whatever you wish....I choose to follow my Master and Holy God! Blessings and Peace

1 0 Reply Share ›

Peterkeppel

14 years ago

bet this wont get posted-but why did jesus tell us in mathew 24-when speaking of the end of the world and all the horrible things to happen-..."pray that your flight is not in winter OR ON THE SABBATH DAY" also-when jesus showed himself to mary,then the disciples(who as the verse you quoted says were hiding in fear of the jews,sounds a bit different from a worship service)and before his ascension-what passage is that again where jesus says "I now command you to stop observing the JEWISH sabath and keep my ressurection day holy..."???? One last question--would the church support or not legislation everywhere TO ENFORCE the observance of sunday ....with consequenses ?just curious

1 0 Reply Share ›

Keith

15 years ago

Dear Brother André Marie,
Unfortunately the truth was never popular.

"When you don't have a Church with authority to teach in Christ's name, you're stuck with making it up as you go along." - this seems like a real strawman. The initial apostles who were led by the Holy Spirit may have been a bit dismayed by this, surely they didn't "make things up" as they went. No, they had their scriptures, the teachings of Christ and were led by the Holy Spirit.

So too today, around the world are many Christian men and women, across denominations who preach the word of God through the scriptures and are led through the Holy Spirit.

Also, allow me to point out that not everybody got the day wrong as for a "millenium and half", as you believe. I refer you to the Jewish nation who to this day, keep the God ordained Sabbath day.

Bible is no longer banned by the Roman Catholic church, you are now free to study it. You will be amazed at what you will find.

1 0 Reply Share ›

Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → Keith

15 years ago

Keith: The Jews don't accept Jesus Christ. They have gotten it wrong for MORE than a millennium and a half. That a Seventy-Day Christian would use Judaic practices to justify his own speaks a lot of the tendencies of this novel sect.

The "straw man" you accuse me of building is actually more robust than you think. The apostles and others who taught by the Spirit of God and had the Old Testament Scriptures and wrote the New Testament Scriptures: They WERE the authorities in the Church then.

1 0 Reply Share ›

John Alexander

16 years ago

Another thought, you say Jesus Rose from His death on Sunday so you celebrate. He is God He would have risen the very next moment, but He decided to keep the sabbath even in His death for man to remember that this day is not the day to feast and celebrate. I hope you can think now. I did not understand head or tail on how you conclude that Sunday is the sabbath. You just drag and drag on something which does not stand in the Bible. There can be no one who can be God and make people saints, except God Himself. Pray and pray and God will give you wisdom.

1 0 Reply Share ›

Milton

17 years ago

Just be honest to yourself. Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to lead you to the truth, and the truth will set you free!
Questions to ponder:
Is Sunday the true Sabbath?
Is Sabbath keeping still relevant for us today?
Will we be celebrating Sabbath in Heaven?
Did Jesus observe any Sunday worship?

Read the Bible for yourself and you'll find the truth!

God bless.

1 0 Reply Share ›

H Rictor

4 years ago

Revelation 14:12 Here is the patience of the saints: here
are they that keep the commandments of God, and the faith of
Jesus.

Matthew 5:17 Think not that I am come to destroy
the law, or the prophets: I am not come to destroy, but to
fulfil.

Daniel 7:25 And he shall speak great words against the
most High, and shall wear out the saints of the most High, and think to change times
and laws: and they shall be given into his hand until a time and
times and the dividing of time.

Matthew 5:18 & 19 For verily I say unto you,
Till heaven and earth pass, one jot or one tittle shall in no wise pass from
the law, till all be fulfilled. Whosoever therefore shall break one of

these least commandments, and shall teach men so, he shall be called the least in the kingdom of heaven: but whosoever shall do and teach them, the same shall be called great in the kingdom of heaven.

see more

0 0 Reply Share ›

John

9 years ago

for one the Sabbath Commandment was made right after God finished creation, before the Jews existed before the tower of Babel, and Jesus is Lord of the Sabbath, and also Jesus said if you LOVE me keep my Commandments not 9 of them 10 of them and he didn't tell us to take 2nd Commandment out you know the one about idols,and he didn't tell us to split the 10th Commandment into 2 separate ones.

0 0 Reply Share ›

Ben

10 years ago

From Catholicisms own writings:

-"You may read the Bible from Genesis to Revelation, and you will not find a single line authorizing the sanctification of Sunday. The Scriptures enforce the religious observance of Saturday, a day which we never sanctify." The Faith of Our Fathers, by James Cardinal Gibbons, Archbishop of Baltimore, 88th edition, page 89. Originally published in 1876, republished and Copyright 1980 by TAN Books and Publishers, Inc., pages 72-73.

- "The Sabbath was Saturday, not Sunday. The Church altered the observance of the Sabbath to the observance of Sunday. Protestants must be rather puzzled by the keeping of Sunday when God distinctly said, 'Keep holy the Sabbath Day.' The word Sunday does not come anywhere in the Bible, so, without knowing it they are obeying the authority of the Catholic Church." Canon Cafferata, The Catechism Explained, p. 89.

- "If Protestants would follow the Bible, they would worship God on the Sabbath Day. In keeping the Sunday they are following a law of the Catholic Church." Albert Smith, Chancellor of the Archdiocese of Baltimore, replying for the Cardinal, in a letter dated February 10, 1920.

- "It is well to remind the Presbyterians, Baptists, Methodists, and all other Christians, that the

see more

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Ben

10 years ago

Daniel 7:1-8, 24-25

- (Verse 1): Here in Daniel 7 we find that Daniel has another dream. Remember he was shown in a dream what King Nebuchadnezzar's dream meant in Daniel 2.

- And this dream has meaning for us right now as we are about to find out, just like the Dream in Daniel 2 did.

- (Verses 2-3): Right away we see that there is a lot of symbolism here. But what does it all mean? How can we even know what it all means? That's a good question, and we are going to let the Bible tell us.

- If you let it the Bible will interpret itself for you. We don't have to guess at what these symbols mean. We can find the answer in the Word of God.

- So let's look at what the Bible says some of these symbols mean.

- (Winds): Most of the time when we think of winds in our world today it is usually associated with something destructive (Tornados, Hurricanes, ect…).

see more

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Ben → Ben

10 years ago

- Let's go through the list of the ten identifying characteristics and see if it all fits.

- 1. Comes up after Rome is divided: Did the Roman Catholic Church arise after Rome was divided? Rome was divided in 476 AD and the Roman Catholic Church came to power in 538 AD.

- On September 4, 476 AD the last Roman Emperor, Romulus Augustus, was deposed and removed from power by a German Barbarian named Odoacer, who proclaimed himself king of Italy.

- So the Roman Catholic Church did not come to complete power until 538 AD, long after Rome was divided.

- In order to fully come to power the Roman Catholic Church had to become both a church and a state. We are going to show you that this little horn power received both ecclesiastical and political power in 538 AD, and that ties in with the other identifying characteristic about it being different than all the other horns.

- 2. Comes up from among the ten divisions of Rome: Did the Roman Catholic Church

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ZenInsight

13 years ago

http://www.europeansundayal...

Watch out...Sabbath persecution is coming.

0 0 Reply Share ›

Wow

13 years ago

Christians believe in Jesus, that is what "Christian" means. Jesus said " If you love me keep my

Christians believe in Jesus, that is what "Christian" means. Jesus said, "If you love me keep my commandments." John 14:15 At the time He was in the process of educating His followers--preparing them to be leaders in the future Christian church.

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michael Omoya

15 years ago

Bless your soul dear bro of the above article,

I'm impressed that you really want to know the truth as it is written in the Holy Scriptures.Because it is only after we have known the truth for selves that we are thus set free by the truth,Now the Bible says in John 17;17 that "sanctify them through thy truth, thy word is truth". in psalms 119:50, it written "thy word is lamp unto my feet, and light unto my path". Truth is thus predicated by God ALONE,as such it exist irregardless of our perception or preonceived ideas. thereore if you wish to know whether God Changed His day of worship or not you simply have to consult the word of God for your self.Lastly when studying the bible we advise that you apply the principle found in Isaiah 28;10, that is to say you allow the Bible to be its own expositor, make use of the concordance as and when studying the Bible for vivid reference to a particular passage of scripture of interest.

May the Good Lord richly bless your effort, i hope to see you by faith, in the blessed kingdom of our Lord and Only Saviour Jesus Christ...

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WalterE

16 years ago

Interesting reading...

http://www.sabbathtruth.com...

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WalterE

16 years ago

Good day dear brother of the article above,

You state “The Church commands us to keep Sunday as the Lord’s day because on Sunday Christ rose from the dead.”

The Church has not the authority to change Gods immutable law. Man has not the authority to change Gods law, not me, not you, nor the the "Vicar of Christ."
Satan had to produce a deceptive counterfeit to replace Gods law. Sunday worhip was exactly that. Daniel and the Revelation is quite open and straighforward about how the end iof time will unfold. Simply put, it will be the Sabbath keepers on one side and the non Sabbath keepers on the other; it will be the children of God on one side, and the followers of Satan on the other. It will be the keepers of Gods holy immutable law on the one side and it will be the followers and keepers of Satans deceptions and man's man made laws on the other.

I believe " God commands us to keep the seventh day as the Sabbath," Gods law is immutable, it stands forever, it is the Alpha and Omega.

God gave us the choice. Isn't that beautiful?

God gave us the choice. Isn't that beautiful?

see more

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Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → WalterE

16 years ago

Walter: When you don't have a Church with authority to teach in Christ's name, you're stuck with making it up as you go along. Having made up the seventh-day dogma, you're also stuck with the historical absurdity of Christianity failing for over a millennium and a half to preserve the proper God-mandated day of worship -- until, that is, an American woman discovers what everybody else got wrong. You are also doomed to be inconsistent when you don't consider every prescription of the Old Testament law binding unless it, too, was explicitly abrogated in the New Testament. Stoning disobedient sons, ritually purifying women after childbirth, the festivals of pilgrimage, the prohibition on blood-meats, and other aspects of the Old Law were not specifically abrogated in the New. And whatever your answers are to these objections, it matters little. Your church is not infallible, therefore what we're dealing with is your opinion of how the Scriptures are to be interpreted.

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ZenInsight → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

13 years ago

Your response proves the inadequacy of the Catholic churches desperate attempt to display the power they believe they have over God's laws. The Bible is infallible. Not the Catholic church.

Consider 1 Timothy 2:5

For there is one God and one mediator between God and men, the man Christ Jesus,

This the infallible Catholic churches response to the clear instruction of the Bible.

Leo XIII, Jucunda Semper, 1894: "When Mary offered herself completely to God together with her Son in the temple, she was already sharing with him the painful atonement on behalf of the human race ... (at the foot of cross) she willingly offered him up to the divine justice, dying with him in her heart, pierced by the sword of sorrow."

Pius X, Ad Diem Illum, 1904: "Owing to the union of suffering and purpose

see more

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Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. Mod → ZenInsight

13 years ago

ZenInsight: Your post helps to show the intellectual depravity of *sola*

scriptura. Seventh Day Adventists, and other Seventy-Day denominations are among the many Judaizing sects spawned by the Protestant Revolution. In the absence of tradition and legitimate God-ordained authority, such things become possible.

The fact is, the keeping of Sunday worship has existed in Christ's Church *ab intio, semper, ubique, et ab omnibus* (from the beginning, always, everywhere, and by everyone). The idea that, after Martin Luther and John Calvin started their revolt -- neither of whom held the that Saturday was to be kept as the Christian sabbath -- there would arise sectarians who would correct Christ's Church in this or any other matter is a stunning reminder of the folly of human conceit.

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ZenInsight → Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M.

13 years ago

How about we let the Bible speak for itself?

Acts 20:7

7 On the first day of the week we came together to break bread. Paul spoke to the
people and, because he intended to leave the next day, kept on talking until
midnight.

Paul kept 85 Sabbaths (see at the bottom of the comment). The first day of the week begins at sundown in the past (now at midnight). Since Paul was leaving the next morning, he had been preaching all day Sabbath and continued into the evening (Sunday, until midnight). Then left in the morning. Careful of taking things
out of context, that happens to many true seekers.

1 Corinthians 16:2 New
International Version (NIV)

see more

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John Alexander

16 years ago

The adventist Church is true and believe what God wants them to do. You can't have a God who can change today and tommorrow. He is a God of the universe and so His law and rule stands for all not only for the Jews. Sadly it seems you view the adventist beliefs with a thought of concluding that Sunday is the sabbath. It is also sad you are left with no defence that you tell the priest performs rituals everyday. So does most christans they pray to God everyday. Pray and ask God for wisdom and don't fall down to worldly men for Knowledge.

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Brian Kelly

17 years ago

Ed,

I am sorry for not replying sooner.

You bypass all of the arguments in the above article and present a couple of quotes, which you assume justifies your position, when, in fact, the intention of the Catholic sources that you quote was to demonstrate that the Church established by Jesus Christ does have authority from "the Lord of the Sabbath" to establish Sunday as the day of Christian rest and mandatory worship at Holy Mass.

In defending the Church's divinely established authority, which is so very clear from scripture — you are familiar with the texts, no doubt — the Catechism and the "Catholic Mirror" were simply granting the argument that there is no explicit New Testament text dealing with this change. Certainly, there are implicit texts that would indicate that the early Church was slowly establishing Sunday as the "Lord's Day," all of which are provided in Mr. Michael's article.

The point that the author made concerning the "perpetual" covenant of circumcision being abolished, as is clear in Acts and Galatians, would argue also for the Sabbath, even though the New Testament does not explicitly address the latter issue. The history of the early Church

see more

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Ed

17 years ago

"You may read the Bible from Genesis to Revelation, and you will not find a single line authorizing the sanctification of Sunday. The Scriptures enforce the religious observance of Saturday, a day which we never sanctify." (Cardinal Gibbons, The Faith of Our Fathers - 92nd ed.rev. Baltimore, John Murphy Company, pg. 89)

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The Slaves of the Immaculate Heart of Mary were founded in 1949 by Father Leonard Feeney, M.I.C.M. Founding Superior of Saint Benedict Center, N.H.: Brother Francis, M.I.C.M. (Fakhri B. Maluf, Ph.D.), RIP
Prior: Brother André Marie, M.I.C.M. | Prioress: Sister Mary Peter, M.I.C.M.

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Extra ecclesiam nulla salus (outside the Church there is no salvation).